



MCKENZIE RIVER VALLEY · SELLING YOUR HOME · FALL 2026

Sell with confidence, not *hope*

Up river, the well, the septic, the bank and the road in all carry value a buyer has to see on paper. This guide walks the whole sale in order, from the first walk of your property to the day the deed records, so you know what is coming and what to have ready.



5

BUSINESS DAYS EARNEST MONEY IS
TYPICALLY DUE AFTER ACCEPTANCE

10

BUSINESS DAYS A BUYER TYPICALLY
HAS TO INSPECT

30-45

DAYS FROM ACCEPTED OFFER TO
CLOSING ON A TYPICAL OREGON
CONTRACT



This is my *river* too

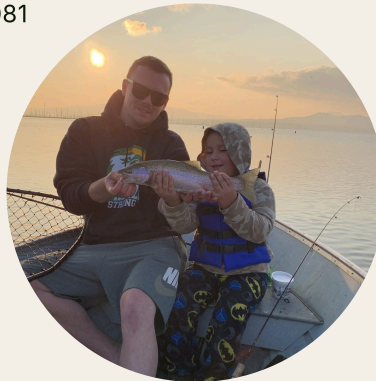
I live in the McKenzie Valley, and I fish this river every chance I get. I sell homes on the same corridor I drive home on: Springfield and Thurston, up through Walterville, Cedar Flat, Deerhorn, Leaburg, Vida, Nimrod, Finn Rock, Blue River and Rainbow to McKenzie Bridge, plus Camp Creek, the Mohawk Valley and Eugene.

Selling out here is not the same job it is in town. Wells and septic systems decide value. Flood maps shape a buyer's loan. The closest comparable sale might be three miles away and nothing like your place. A sign in the yard is not a plan.

So here is mine. I will price your property honestly, prepare it properly, market it past the valley, and negotiate it like the money is my own. I practice with The Operative Group, brokered by Real Broker, so a neighbor's local knowledge comes with a full team's marketing reach and transaction support behind it.

Keep this guide on the kitchen table, write in the margins, and text me when a page raises a question.

George Winters · Real Broker LLC · Oregon Lic# 201251081





The whole sale, in *order*

1. **The walk.** I walk your property with you before I say a number. Rain is fine. Rain is better, actually.
2. **The number.** The sales I think compare, what the online estimates say, and four prices to choose from.
3. **The paperwork.** The listing agreement, Oregon's agency pamphlet, and your disclosure statement started.
4. **The records file.** Well, septic, permits, survey, easements, flood zone. Gathered before we list.
5. **The shortest list.** The few fixes that return more than they cost.
6. **Photos in the right light.** The setting at its best and its most honest.
7. **Go live.** The MLS, the big search sites, a Just Listed post, and reach past the valley.
8. **Showings.** Buyers come out, and I tell you what they say.
9. **Offers.** Every term, not just the price.
10. **Inspection, appraisal and title.** The buyer looks closely, the lender checks value, title clears the way.
11. **Closing.** You sign, the deed records, your proceeds are released.
12. **After the keys.** Contractors, well drillers, firewood leads. Out here that is part of the job.

Every step has a deadline in your contract. I track them all and tell you where things stand before you ask.

Text 541-870-8378 to set up a walk →



PART ONE

Before the *sign*

The walk, the number, the records and the shortest list. Most of what decides your result is settled before the first buyer pulls into the drive.





Comps come after the *walk*

No algorithm prices frontage, timber or a strong well, so I start on your ground. We walk it together, and I look at what a buyer will: the first hundred feet of the drive, the view path to the water, the outbuildings, the systems and the house.

Before I come out, jot down your answers to these:

- **When do you need to be out, and where are you headed next?**
- **What do you need to walk away with?** A rough number is fine.
- **What do you know that a buyer cannot see?** How the well does in August. What the river did in a high-water year. How the road holds up in winter. What was built, and when.

Who I work for

When you list with me, I work for you. Oregon law says I owe you loyalty, care, confidentiality, disclosure of what I learn, and an honest accounting of every dollar and document. Your bottom line and your reasons for selling stay with me.

I also owe every buyer honesty, and I must disclose material defects I know about. That works in your favor if you tell me early: a known problem can be priced, fixed or explained. Before we sign, you get Oregon's initial agency disclosure pamphlet, which lays this out in the state's words.

How I am paid

My fee is in our listing agreement, and it is negotiable. Since August 2024, the MLS no longer shows what a seller offers a buyer's broker, and buyers sign their own written agreement with their broker. Whether you offer anything toward the buyer's broker is your call, set before we list or worked out inside an offer. Nothing gets paid that you have not approved in writing.



The algorithm never stood on your *bank*

You have probably looked your place up online. Up river, that number misses more often than in town, for plain reasons. There are too few sales to average. The water is invisible to the models: bank height, current and a gravel bar to launch from are in no database. Usable acres, timber and a shop with power get squeezed into a lot size. A strong, documented well is a five-figure fact the data never sees. And Leaburg is not Nimrod, and Nimrod is not Vida. Buyers know that. The algorithm does not.

I still pull the estimates. You will see Zillow, Redfin, Realtor.com and the RPR side by side, and where they fall against my number. They are a sanity check, not a pricing opinion.

Pricing a place with no twin

- **Name what kind of river it is.** Frontage, where you own to the water. View, where you see it from the deck. Access, where you can walk or drive to it. Three products, priced three ways.
- **Read the frontage.** A high, stable bank with a launch spot sells differently than low meadow frontage that floods in winter. I will tell you what yours is worth to a buyer.
- **Price the systems as line items.** A documented strong well, a septic that matches the bedroom count and a shop with power are real dollars.
- **Argue every comparable.** The sales I use are ones I know on this corridor, and every adjustment comes with a reason you can push back on.

A price you can explain survives the negotiation and the appraisal. A price you hoped for ends up funding the buyer's.



05 · FOUR PRICES

Choosing a number with our eyes *open*

I do not hand you one number and hope you like it. I bring a pricing matrix: four prices, what each assumes, and roughly what each nets you after the costs of selling.

THE PRICE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT IT ASKS OF YOU
Aspirational	The top of what your place could bring if everything lines up: the right buyer, the right season, little competition	Patience, fewer early showings, and a real chance we change the price later
Perceived market value	Where recent sales say buyers will see your property today	Where most sellers land
Event	A little under market value, priced to bring buyers out the first week and let them compete	Comfort letting the market set the final number
Worst case	What it would likely bring if it had to sell soon, or the market softened	Nothing. It is the floor we plan around

Then we choose together. I will tell you which one I would pick and why, even when it is not the one you hoped for.

What "start high and see" costs

The first two weeks bring the most attention a listing ever gets. Priced right, they bring the buyers who have been waiting for a place like yours. Priced high, they teach buyers to wait. A later price change does not reset the clock, and buyers can see the history. Run your own numbers:

CARRYING COST	YOUR NUMBER
Mortgage, taxes and insurance, per month	
Power, propane or firewood, internet, upkeep, per month	
Months a high price might add	
What "start high and see" could cost you	

Ask me for the four-price matrix on your place, with an estimated net at each price.

Text 541-870-8378 →



Spend on evidence of *care*

Not every dollar spent before listing comes back, and out here the ones that do are rarely the ones people expect. Kitchens and baths matter less than access, water and the view path.

WORTH DOING

USUALLY NOT WORTH DOING

Open the view path to the water. Limb up and clear the sight line, after checking the riparian rules in section 09

A full kitchen or bath remodel. You rarely get it back

Fix the first hundred feet. Gate, drive, approach. It sets the price a buyer expects before they are out of the car

New flooring throughout. Clean and sound beats new and wrong

Service the systems. Well flow test, septic pumped, chimney swept, receipts kept

Every item on an old inspection. Some belong in the negotiation

Make outbuildings read as assets. Swept, lit, leftovers gone

Major landscaping. The valley does that for you

Moss, gutters and drainage. Cheap, and the difference between cared for and put off

Staging the character out. Buyers come up river for something real

Inside, edit more than stage. Blinds open, tired paint touched up, counters clear, closets thinned, boots and rods out of the frame. Pack what you will not need for two months.

Two Oregon rules that come with a sale

- **Smoke and carbon monoxide alarms.** Oregon requires working smoke alarms, and carbon monoxide alarms where there is a source: a wood stove, a propane or gas appliance, an attached garage. Most homes out here have one. Test them now.
- **Uncertified wood stoves.** Oregon requires an uncertified wood stove or fireplace insert to be removed and destroyed when the home sells. Some are exempt. Photograph the label on the back of the stove and send it to me before we list.

Inspect first?

On an older or rural home, a pre-listing inspection buys you the upper hand. You fix surprises at contractor prices on your own schedule, or price them in, instead of negotiating them on a buyer's deadline. I start with the systems: well, septic, wood heat. Whatever it finds becomes something you know, and it goes on your disclosure.



07 · THE RECORDS FILE

The *file* that defends your price

River and rural buyers ask sharp questions. When your property answers with documents instead of shrugs, inspections go quieter and appraisals go smoother. So we build the file before we list.

WHAT GOES IN

WHERE IT USUALLY COMES FROM

Well log	Oregon Water Resources Department. I can look yours up
Well flow test, pump and tank records	Your well company
The state well water test	Booked early in prep (section 08)
Septic permit, design, pumping records	Lane County records, your pumper
Permits for additions, shops, barns, second dwellings, rebuilds	Lane County, or the city inside city limits
Survey, corner pins, easements	Your purchase papers, the county surveyor, title
Road maintenance agreement	Your records, your neighbors, the county recorder
Flood zone, elevation certificate, flood insurance history	FEMA's map, a surveyor, your insurance agent
Permits for bank work, stairs, decks or a dock	Lane County and the state
Water rights certificates	Oregon Water Resources Department
Wood stove label, chimney sweep receipts	The back of the stove, your sweep
Big-ticket receipts with dates	Roof, heat, water heater, windows, treatment system
Defensible space and fire rebuild records	Your photos and receipts, Lane County permits

Almost nobody has all of it. Gather what you have, and I will help rebuild the rest.



Every question answered before listing is a discount you never give at negotiation.

Text 541-870-8378 to start your file →

08 · THE OREGON DISCLOSURE

Disclose like the buyer will find *everything*

Because the good ones will. Most Oregon sellers must give buyers a Seller's Property Disclosure Statement, a form set in state law covering title, water, septic or sewer, structure, systems and permits. You answer each question yes, no or unknown.

- **It asks what you know.** You are not expected to inspect your own house. "Unknown" is honest when it is true. A guess is not.
- **The buyer gets a window.** A buyer has five business days after receiving your disclosure to revoke their offer, unless they waive it. If it is never delivered, that right can last until closing. So I want yours done before we list.
- **Some sales are exempt,** including certain estate and trust sales. I will tell you if yours is.
- **If something changes,** a leak, a failed pump, water where it should not be, tell me that day.
- **"As is" does not change this.** As is speaks to repairs, not to what you know.

What a rural or river disclosure usually touches: flooding you have seen and any claims, bank work and its permits, buildings without permits, a septic sized for fewer bedrooms than the house now has, easements and shared roads, water rights, and fire history. Out here we handle that last one plainly, with the paperwork.

Homes built before 1978. Federal law requires a lead-based paint disclosure, any reports you have, and a pamphlet for the buyer, who also gets up to 10 days to test unless they waive it.

Homes on a domestic well. Oregon requires the seller to have the water tested at sale for arsenic, nitrates and total coliform bacteria, give the results to the buyer, and report them to the Oregon Health Authority. We book it during prep.

An honest, complete disclosure protects you long after closing. Let's fill it in together.

Text 541-870-8378 →



Owning the *water*, on paper

River buyers fall for the water first and read the paperwork second. Both have to hold up.

- **Your flood zone.** If your home sits in a FEMA high-risk zone, one starting with A, a buyer with a federally backed loan must carry flood insurance. I pull the zone on every river property before a buyer's lender does.
- **An elevation certificate.** Find yours if you have one. If your home is mapped into a flood zone but sits well above the water, a surveyor's certificate can lower what a buyer pays for insurance, and can support asking FEMA to amend the map.
- **Flood history.** If water has reached the house, the shop, the well head or the drive, write down when and what you did. Same for insurance claims. A plain account beats a buyer hearing it from a neighbor.
- **Riparian setbacks.** The strip along the bank has its own rules for building and cutting. Before you clear anything for the view, we check with Lane County. A careful view corridor is often allowed. Clearing the bank can bring a restoration order.
- **Bank work, stairs, decks and docks.** Work near or below the water line can involve Lane County, Oregon's Department of State Lands, and sometimes the Army Corps of Engineers. Gather any permits behind riprap, stairs or a dock. If something went in without one, tell me. It belongs on the table before an offer, not after an inspection.
- **The bank itself.** Has it moved in your time there? Photos from a high-water winter are worth digging out.

Buyers buy the bank, not just the view. The bank is what they will maintain and insure, so it is what we document.



The systems buyers *ask* about first

The well. Beyond the required test, buyers often order a flow test and look at the pump, pressure tank and any treatment. A recent flow test of your own, gallons per minute written down, turns your well from a question into a selling point. A proper cap, clear access and a labeled pressure system photograph and inspect better. If you share a well, find the written agreement. If a test shows a problem, most have known fixes, and a solved problem with paperwork lands better than an unknown.

Water rights. Using water and having the right to use it are different things in Oregon. A household well usually runs under an exemption for domestic use. Irrigating from the river, a creek, a pond or a well beyond household use usually rests on a water right on file with the state.

- **If you irrigate, find the certificate or permit.** It spells out the source, use, season, amount and the land it serves.
- **Rights generally go with the land they serve.** Oregon expects the seller to tell the buyer in writing what water right documents exist and hand them over, and the state's record gets updated to the new owner.
- **A right can be lost to non-use.** Five years in a row unused can forfeit it. If yours has sat idle, tell me.
- **"Water rights included" is a claim** until the state record backs it. I check before it goes in the listing.

Septic. Gather the permit, design and pumping records. Lane County's records show how many bedrooms the system was sized for. If a den became a bedroom, the house may claim more than the permit supports, so we market the bedrooms the permit supports and call the rest an office. Lenders and appraisers check. Pump and inspect before listing if it has been a few years. If something fails, we get it scoped first and decide second. A priced problem is just a term in the deal.



The road in, and the *ground* around it

- **Access and easements.** Is your road public, private or shared, and is any easement you rely on recorded? The title report shows some of it. You know the rest.
- **Road maintenance.** On a shared road, a recorded maintenance agreement answers who fixes the potholes and plows the snow. Some lenders ask. If there is none, we price that in.
- **Outbuildings and unpermitted structures.** Shops, barns, studios, a second dwelling: were they permitted? An unpermitted building is not the end of a sale, but it has to be disclosed and can affect value, lending and insurance.
- **A manufactured home on the land.** Find its title paperwork. How it is titled matters to the lender and the title company.
- **Farm or forest tax deferral.** Tell me. The contract should say who pays if the deferral ends.
- **Wood heat.** A swept chimney with a receipt and a clean installation make a buyer's insurer comfortable.
- **Defensible space.** Clean and lean around the buildings, fuel thinned farther out. The Oregon State Fire Marshal and local fire districts publish guidance, and many offer free assessments. Photograph the work and keep receipts. Insurers ask.
- **Rebuilt after the 2020 Holiday Farm Fire?** Gather the permits and final inspections, records for any new well or septic, hazard tree work, and any replanting obligations from salvage logging, which can transfer with the land. What burned and what was rebuilt goes on the disclosure, said plainly.



A SWEEP, LIT SHOP READS AS AN ASSET. THE SAME SHOP FULL OF LEFTOVERS READS AS A PROJECT.



PART TWO

Marketed, not *posted*

Light, reach and a listing that answers questions before buyers ask.
River buyers come from Portland, from Bend and from out of state,
and they decide from a long way off whether your place is worth
the drive.





Light matters more out *here*

A buyer three hundred miles away meets your place through photos first.

- **The setting, in the light it deserves.** Golden-hour light on the water, the frontage, the shop. Honest and beautiful at once, because a buyer who feels misled at the showing leaves.
- **Video that carries the place.** The river audible, and drone footage that shows the frontage and the shape of the land.
- **The season.** Fall photographs the corridor gold. Winter buyers are fewer but serious. If your best season is not your listing season, we can photograph now and list later.



FALL ON THE MCKENZIE. SUMMER FRONTAGE CAN BE PHOTOGRAPHED NOW FOR A LATER LISTING.

WHEN

WHAT HAPPENS

A month or more out	The walk and the number. Records file started. Well test and septic pumping booked
Two to three weeks out	Shortest list done, disclosure finished, packing started
The week before	Clean, mow, open the view path. Photo and video day, timed for the light
Go-live day	On the MLS and the big search sites. The Just Listed post goes out
The weeks after	Showings, feedback, and updates from me before you ask

If a coming-soon period suits your place, MLS rules decide what it allows. I will lay out the options first.



Reach past the *valley*

Your buyer may live in Eugene, in Portland or three states away. River property is a destination purchase, and the marketing behaves like it.

- **A listing that answers questions.** Well, septic, heat, access, flood zone, internet. What river buyers ask on the phone goes in the listing.
- **Reach past the valley.** The deep Eugene and Springfield pool first, then Portland, Bend and out of state, using my team's marketing reach.
- **The corridor network.** Fourteen communities and the agents, contractors and neighbors who work them. Some of the best buyers hear about a place before it ever reaches a search site.

The posts that follow your listing

Each change in your sale gets its own post: your photo, the status across it, and my contact details.

POST	WHEN	WHAT IT SHOWS
Just Listed	The day you go live	The price
Open House	Ahead of one	The price, the day and time
New Price	Only if we change it	Old price struck through, new price. Never "reduced"
Under Contract	When we accept an offer	The status only
Just Sold	After closing	The price only if you say it may be shared

While you are active, I keep your listing in front of people week after week. Every post describes the property, never who it suits, and is shown to every buyer. Fair housing is part of how I market.



Making the drive *worth* it

- **Tell me where the map apps go wrong.** Up river they often do. Landmarks and the right gate go in the showing instructions.
- **Gates, dogs and livestock.** Codes, where the dogs will be, which fences are electric.
- **Leave during showings.** Buyers talk more openly and stay longer.
- **Lights on, shop open and lit,** and no fire left burning unattended in the stove.
- **Flag the corners** if you know them, and mow a path to the water.
- **Lock up** cash, prescriptions, firearms and papers.
- **Cameras.** Tell me about them so the instructions say so. Oregon law does not allow recording a conversation in person unless the people in it are told, so turn the audio off.
- **Feedback.** I pass along what buyers say, good and not so good.

Open houses matter less up river than in town, because distance buyers tour by appointment and video. Where one helps, usually nearer town, we hold it.

A place that is easy to see gets seen. Say yes to every showing you can in the first two weeks.

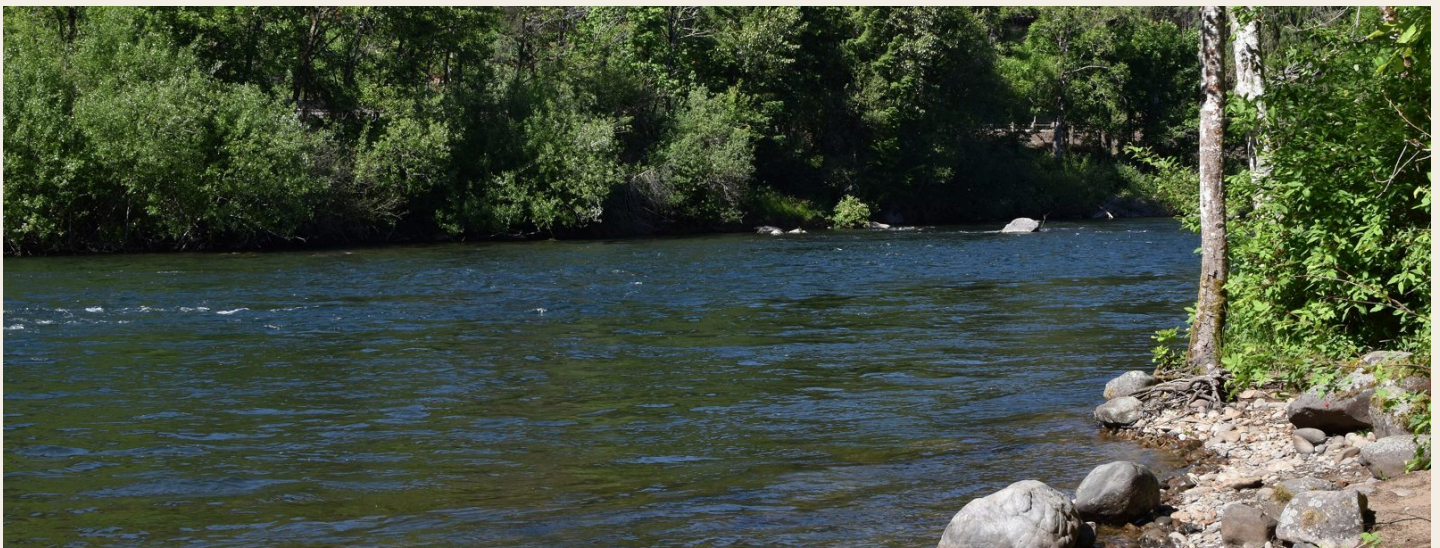
Questions? Text 541-870-8378 →



PART THREE

From offer to *keys*

The negotiation, the rural inspection stack, an appraisal with too few comparable sales, the title work and the day you hand it over.





The highest number is not always the *best* offer

Out here it often is not. We go through every offer together, and when there are several, side by side.

WHAT I WEIGH

WHY IT MATTERS UP RIVER

Price	The headline, and what it nets you
Financing	Cash, conventional, FHA, VA or USDA. Some loan programs look harder at wells, septic, wood heat and access
Appraisal risk	With few comparable sales, a gap is more likely. Can the buyer cover one?
Inspection plan	How many days, and whether they know to test the well and septic
Earnest money	How much, and how fast
Contingencies	Financing, appraisal, the sale of their own home
Dates	Closing and possession. Animals and equipment take time to move
Requests	Closing costs, their broker's pay, the tractor, the generator, the firewood

Your choices: accept, reject or counter. A counter is a new offer the buyer can accept, reject or counter back. With several offers, we can ask everyone for their best terms or counter more than one, worded carefully. **A back-up offer** waits behind the first and moves up if the first falls apart.

I negotiate with the records file in hand and the numbers in front of me.

The first week, and the *inspection* stack

Once you accept, the contract goes to the title company, a neutral party that holds the money and gathers what is needed to close. Earnest money arrives, usually within a few business days. Your disclosure goes out if it has not, starting the buyer's five-business-day window. Title issues a preliminary report.



Contingencies are what the deal depends on: the inspection (often 10 business days), the loan, the appraisal, sometimes the sale of the buyer's home.

On a rural property, inspection is a stack. Expect a home inspection, a well flow and water test, a septic inspection, a chimney and stove check, pests and dry rot, and sometimes a survey, a look at the bank, and insurance quotes. Our file answers much of it before they start.

THE BUYER ASKS FOR

YOUR CHOICES

Repairs

Some, all or none, done by licensed contractors with receipts

A credit at closing

Often cleaner. They fix it their way

A lower price

Weigh it against the real fix, and the cost of relisting

Nothing

It happens. Enjoy it

If the septic or well fails, we get it scoped before we negotiate. A cracked baffle and a worn-out drainfield are different worlds. If a buyer walks, what their inspection found is now something you know, and your next disclosure says so.



17 · THE APPRAISAL

When the appraiser has few *comps*

If the buyer is borrowing, the lender orders an appraisal. Up river, this is where a well-priced sale can stumble. Comparable sales are thin, and an appraiser from out of the area can miss what frontage, a strong well or a good shop are worth.

So the appraiser gets the records file, your improvements with dates and costs, and the sales I used with the reason each compares. I am glad to meet them at the property and walk it, the way I walked it with you.

THE APPRAISAL COMES IN WHAT USUALLY HAPPENS

At or above the price	The loan moves ahead
Below the price	Lower the price, the buyer brings cash, we split it, or we ask the lender to reconsider with better comparable sales
Well below, no agreement	A buyer with an appraisal or financing contingency may be able to end the deal with their earnest money back

The argument that set your price is the one that defends it.

18 · TITLE, ESCROW AND TAXES

What the title company *needs*

- **The preliminary title report** shows liens, easements and road rights. An old lien, a co-owner who has passed away, a divorce, or a property in a trust or estate can be sorted out, but it takes time. Tell me early.
- **Who signs.** Everyone on title. A power of attorney needs title's approval ahead of time.
- **Title insurance.** In Oregon the seller customarily pays for the buyer's owner's policy. The buyer pays for the lender's.
- **Escrow** is commonly split evenly here. Most sales close with a statutory warranty deed.
- **No transfer tax.** Oregon has none, and neither does Lane County. Washington County is the one exception in the state. You pay small recording fees.
- **Property taxes** run on a July 1 to June 30 year and are split at closing.
- **If you live outside Oregon or the United States,** Oregon can have title hold back part of your proceeds for state income tax, and federal FIRPTA rules can require withholding up to 15% from a foreign seller. Tell me at the start.



- **Tax on your gain.** Many who lived in the home two of the last five years owe little. Land, a second home or a rental is different. Ask your tax professional before we list.

19 · NET PROCEEDS

What actually *lands* in your account

Fill in what you know, and I will build a real estimate for the rest.

LINE	WHAT IT IS	YOUR NUMBER
Sale price	The price in your contract	
Minus mortgage payoff	Every loan and credit line, with interest to payoff day	
Minus listing broker	Per our listing agreement	
Minus buyer's broker	Only if you offer or agree to it	
Minus owner's title policy	Customarily the seller's cost in Oregon	
Minus half the escrow fee	Commonly split with the buyer	
Minus recording fees	Small county and title charges	
Minus or plus property taxes	Your share of the tax year. Paid ahead, you get credited	
Minus well test and septic work	The required water test, plus any pumping or inspection	
Minus wood stove removal	Only for an uncertified stove	
Minus repairs and credits	Anything agreed after inspection	
Minus other costs	A survey, liens, a home warranty if you offer one	
Estimated net	Before moving costs and any tax on your gain	

Know your number before you list, not at the signing table.

Text 541-870-8378 for your net estimate →



Handing it *over*

- **Possession** is the date and time in your contract. If you need a few more days, we negotiate a rent-back in writing.
- **What stays.** Out here the line blurs: the generator, the hot tub, shop equipment, an irrigation pump, the firewood stack. Tell me early what you are taking, and we write it down before we list.
- **Utilities.** Final readings on closing day with EWEB, SUB, Lane Electric or whoever serves you. Sort out propane, owned or leased. Keep insurance until the deed records.
- **Leave what only you know:** keys, gate remotes and codes, manuals, where the septic lid is, where the water shuts off, which breaker runs the well pump.

Closing day. You sign at the title company, often a day or two before the closing date, after we go through your settlement statement line by line. Once the buyer's loan funds, the deed goes to the county to record. It is not final until it records. Then your proceeds are released, and the new owner gets the keys on the date in your contract.

Give bank details only to the title company, by phone, at a number you looked up yourself. If wiring instructions change by email or text, even one that looks like mine, stop and call.

Save my number: 541-870-8378 →



Questions sellers *ask* me

Interview more than one agent. These questions separate somebody who knows this corridor from somebody about to learn it on your listing.

How did you arrive at my number? By walking your property, then the sales I know on this corridor, each with a reason it compares. If the answer is an online estimate, keep interviewing.

What does my frontage add? Frontage, current, bank condition and setbacks are not one number. I price them from what buyers on this river have paid, and I show you the sales.

Which flood zone am I in, and what does it cost a buyer? I look it up before we list. It shapes a buyer's loan, their insurance and how many buyers you have.

What will you do with my well and septic records? Gather them before we list, so they answer questions instead of raising them.

What if a buyer's lender balks at the wood stove or the access easement? I have had that conversation. A certification label, a sweep's receipt and a recorded easement usually end it.

How often will I hear from you? Often enough that you never wonder where your sale stands.

What happens after closing? I am still here, with the contractors, well drillers and firewood leads you will need.

Will you tell me when I am wrong? Yes. About the price, the preparation, or an offer that looks better than it is. An agent who only agrees with you is not protecting you.

Your home's value means more to me than it does to other agents, because this is my neighborhood too. When homes here sell right, the whole corridor wins.



22 · YOUR PRE-LISTING CHECKLIST

The list for the *fridge*

Work through this before photo day.

PAPERWORK TO GATHER

DONE

Mortgage statements and any equity line

Property tax statement, and any farm or forest deferral notice

Receipts and dates: roof, heat, water heater, windows

Permits for additions, shops, barns, second dwellings, any rebuild

Well log, flow test, pump records. State water test booked

Septic permit, design and pumping records

Flood zone, elevation certificate, flood insurance history

Permits for bank work, stairs, a deck or dock near the water

Water rights certificates, if you irrigate

Survey, easements, road maintenance agreement

Trust, estate, power of attorney or divorce papers, if they apply

THE PROPERTY

DONE

Smoke and carbon monoxide alarms tested

Wood stove label photographed, chimney swept

View path opened, after checking the rules

Gate, drive and approach cleaned up

Shop and outbuildings swept and lit



THE PROPERTY

DONE

Moss, gutters and drainage handled

Well head tidy, septic lid findable

Defensible space done and photographed

Counters cleared, closets thinned

Corners flagged, directions and gate codes written down

Valuables, prescriptions and firearms locked away

A plan for dogs and livestock during showings

23 · WHAT TO DO NEXT

Three things to do this *week*

1. **Start your records file**, with the well and the septic. They take the longest to find.
2. **Write down your numbers**: what you owe, what the place costs to carry each month, and what you need to walk away with.
3. **Text me, and we will walk it**. I will show you what has sold on this corridor and what I think yours will bring.

The walk is free and commits you to nothing. Just a straight conversation, so you can decide when you are ready.

Text 541-870-8378, or find me at mckenzieverrealestate.com. I am a broker with Real Broker LLC and part of The Operative Group, so your sale has a full team behind it and a neighbor up the road who knows your river.